Anna Lieb

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Education

Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA
B.A. in Data Science (Computer Science concentration) & B.A. in Political Science, May 2024
3.95 GPA, summa cum laude with honors in data science

Honors thesis advised by Eni Mustafaraj (Computer Science) and Maneesh Arora (Political Science)
The "Perfect Villain:" A Computational Analysis of Critical Race Theory Controversies and Political Issue Framing in U.S. News. https://repository.wellesley.edu/node/49380

Work Experience

Pew Research Center, Washington, DC
Computational Social Science Research Analyst, Jul. 2026 – present
Computational Social Science Research Assistant, Sept. 2024 – Jul. 2026

Conduct public-facing data science research on social media, online information, geographic analysis, and digital behaviors. Lead and support projects, including creating research plans, building data collection pipelines, conducting analysis with ML/NLP methods, reviewing code, and collaborating across teams. Fact-check, edit, and contribute original writing for reports and articles published by Pew Research Center.

10a Labs, Washington, DC (remote)
Machine Learning Fellow, Jun. – Aug. 2024

Built and deployed a semantic search engine tool with Google Cloud Platform to help analysts explore trends in large-scale text datasets. Prepared reports and presented results to tech industry clients. Trained a classifier to identify potentially harmful online content; applied unsupervised ML to surface patterns in text.

Computational Analysis for Political Science Lab, Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA
Undergraduate Researcher, Apr. 2023 – May 2024
Advised by Profs. Eni Mustafaraj and Maneesh Arora

Studied political issue framing in online news coverage of critical race theory controversy across the U.S. Collected millions of online news articles and analyzed headline text data using time series regression models and NLP techniques including LLM prompt engineering and an augmented topic modeling technique to perform tasks including attribution, frame detection, and stance detection in news articles.

Global Diversity Lab, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA
Undergraduate Research Assistant (funded by MIT UROP), Sept. 2023 – Dec. 2023
Advised by Prof. Evan Lieberman

Assessed the availability of city-level data on climate challenges and local policy responses in Africa. Compiled data from local governments, news articles, scholarly literature, and public datasets to investigate African cities' resilience to climate change. Analyzed text data to identify key indicators for climate pressures and responses.

Human-Centered Ubiquitous Media Lab, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München, Munich, Germany
Summer Research Assistant (funded by NSF IRES), Jun. 2023 – Aug. 2023
Advised by Dr. Albrecht Schmidt

Developed and evaluated a GPT-3.5-based physics education chatbot that uses prompt engineering and internal system messages to offer an automated personal tutoring experience for students. Designed two studies: 1) An observational study to assess modes of student interaction with our AI tutor chatbot, and 2) An online survey to study the effects of AI literacy on students' learning gains in ChatGPT-facilitated tasks.

Human-Computer Interaction Institute, Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA
Summer Research Assistant (funded by NSF REU), Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2022
Advised by Profs. Laura Dabbish and Bogdan Vasilescu

Researched open-source software development community dynamics and developer collaboration on GitHub. Gathered, cleaned, and analyzed data from GitHub to create metrics for maintainers of open-source software projects to promote more diverse and inclusive contributor communities. Developed a metrics dashboard and conducted user testing interviews with open-source software developers to assess the impacts of the dashboard on community dynamics and maintainer behaviors over time.

Peer-reviewed Publications

† denotes non-archival conference proceedings

† Samuel Bestvater, Athena Chapekis, Skyler Seets, **Anna Lieb**, Sono Shah, and Aaron Smith (Jul. 2026). "The Religious Radio Corpus: Building a Large-Scale Dataset of American Faith Broadcasting." *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2026), Burlington, VT. Extended dataset paper available at https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.26249*

† Athena Chapekis, **Anna Lieb**, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith (Jul. 2026). "Investigating Click Behaviors On Google Search Result Pages That Produce an AI Overview." *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2026), Burlington, VT.* https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.04831

† **Anna Lieb**, Athena Chapekis, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith (Jul. 2026). "How Do Parents Use Online Communities? An Analysis of the r/Parenting Subreddit." *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2026), Burlington, VT.*

Anna Lieb, Athena Chapekis, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith (May 2026). "How Do Parents Use Online Communities? An Analysis of the r/Parenting Subreddit." In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM '26), 20(1), 3002–3008*. https://doi.org/10.1609/icwsm.v20i1.42799

† **Anna Lieb**, Maneesh Arora, & Eni Mustafaraj (Jul. 2024). "Creating Targeted, Interpretable Topic Models with LLM-Generated Text Augmentation." *10th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2024), Philadelphia, PA*. https://arxiv.org/abs/2504.17445

Anna Lieb, Maneesh Arora, & Eni Mustafaraj (Jun. 2024). "Online News Coverage of Critical Race Theory Controversies: A Dataset of Annotated Headlines." In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM '24), 18(1), 1979–1990*. https://doi.org/10.1609/icwsm.v18i1.31441

Anna Lieb & Toshali Goel (May 2024). "Student Interaction with NewtBot: An LLM-as-tutor Chatbot for Secondary Physics Education." In *Extended Abstracts of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing*

Systems (CHI EA '24). Association for Computing Machinery, Article 614, 1–8. https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3647957

Huilian Sophie Qiu, **Anna Lieb**, Jennifer Chou, Megan Carneal, Jasmine Mok, Emily Amspoker, Bogdan Vasilescu, & Laura Dabbish (Apr. 2023). "Climate Coach: A Dashboard for Open-Source Maintainers to Overview Community Dynamics." In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '23).* Association for Computing Machinery, Article 552, 1–18. https://doi.org/10.1145/3544548.3581317

Selected Public Writing

Full Pew Research Center publication list at https://www.pewresearch.org/staff/anna-lieb/

Anna Lieb (Oct. 2026). "On Facebook and Instagram, Political Ads Are Increasingly Critical of Data Centers." Pew Research Center (short read).

Anna Lieb & Aaron Smith (Jun. 2026). "Federal agency X accounts are getting far more engagement in the second Trump term than under Biden." Pew Research Center (short read).

Galen Stocking, Regina Widjaya, **Anna Lieb**, Kaitlyn Radde, Aaron Smith & Eileen Yam (May 2026). "Moms, Coaches, Doctors, Entrepreneurs: Who Are America's Health and Wellness Influencers?" Pew Research Center (report).

Anna Lieb, Athena Chapekis, Sono Shah, & Aaron Smith (Nov. 2025). "How Parents Use Online Communities." Pew Research Center (report).

Athena Chapekis & **Anna Lieb** (Jul. 2025). "Google users are less likely to click on links when an AI summary appears in the results." Pew Research Center (short read).

Other Presentations

"Data for Social Impact Panel" (Mar. 2026). With Jay Barchas-Lichtenstein & Kathy Zhang. Invited talk for Student Interdisciplinary Data Initiative, Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA.

"Public Opinion Research & Computational Methods at Pew Research Center" (Feb. 2026). Invited talk for CS 298 / POL1 259: Social Media and Politics, Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA.

"Roundtable on Artificial Intelligence and the Liberal Arts" (Nov. 2023). With Brian Brubach, Carolyn Anderson, Nicholaus Gutierrez, Michelle Lee, Jyontika Kapoor, & Elizabeth Chen. Tanner Conference for Undergraduate Experiences at Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA.

"US-German Collaboration on AI for the Future of Education" (Jun. 2023). Student Consortium Presentation at CHIWORK Annual Meeting on Human-Computer Interaction for Work, Oldenburg, Germany.

"Diversity & Inclusion in Open-Source Software Communities" (Nov. 2022). Tanner Conference for Undergraduate Experiences at Wellesley College, Wellesley, MA.

Extracurricular & Professional Service

Reviewer: IC2S2 2024, ICWSM 2026, IC2S2 2026

ICWSM 2026 Best Reviewer Award | Recognizes 20 reviewers whose reviews are of "especially good quality and usefulness"

Co-Organizer, Tools & Tech sessions, 2024 - present | Host monthly workshops and presentations for Pew Research Center staff to learn about emerging methods and technical skills.

Assistant Instructor, Kode With Klossy, 2020, 2021, 2025 | Taught computer science courses for girls and students with underrepresented gender identities, with a focus on community, diversity, and inclusion in tech.

President, Fusion, 2022 - 2024 | Wellesley College's multiracial student organization

President, Wellesley College Run Club, 2023-2024 | Organized training runs, races, and community events

Peer Writing Tutor, Wellesley College Writing Program, 2021 - 2024

Web Design Volunteer, Develop for Good, 2021 | Conducted UX research and web design for nonprofits

Honors and Awards

Sigma Xi, 2024 | Research honor society

CHI Student Research Competition Winner, 2024 | Third place undergraduate awarded at the ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

Jerome A. Schiff Fellowship, 2023 | Awards excellence in independent undergraduate research with $3,000 in funding to support senior honors thesis work at Wellesley College.

Albright Fellow, 2023 | Fellowship supported by the Madeleine K. Albright Institute for Global Affairs to prepare students to navigate a complex world with empathy, intellectual rigor, and purpose. Funds an international internship ($5,500) and a three-week intensive designed to bridge the gap between academic theory and global practice.

Kode With Klossy Scholar, 2019 | Fully funded summer coding intensive for girls and gender-expansive youth.

Selected Media Coverage

Drew Pittock / *USA Today*. Jun. 4, 2026. "Transparency or confusion: Trump admin's X engagement outpaces Biden's"

Teddy Rosenbluth / *New York Times*. May 7, 2026. "More People Are Getting Health Advice From TikTok and Instagram. Is That a Good Thing?"

Dylan Scott / *Vox*. May 7, 2026. "Do health influencers actually know what they're talking about?"

Andrea Petersen / *Wall Street Journal*. May 7, 2026. "Who Exactly Is That Wellness Influencer? Not Likely a Doctor or Nurse."

Barbara Rodriguez / *19th*. May 7, 2026. "Women lead as health and wellness influencers. Why do so many men have more followers?"

Heather Kelly / *Washington Post*. Nov. 17, 2025. “Screen-time worries send parents in increasingly desperate directions.”

Bethany Braun-Silva / *Good Morning America / ABC News*. Nov. 16, 2025. “Parents turning to online communities for advice.”

Penske Media Corp. et al. v. Google LLC (antitrust lawsuit). Sept. 12, 2025.

Emma Roth / *The Verge*. Aug. 6, 2025. “Google swears it isn’t destroying the web with AI search.”

Thomas Germain / *BBC*. Jul. 29, 2025. “You might be ghosting the internet. Can it survive?”

Jackie Snow / *Quartz*. Jul. 28, 2025. “The old internet is dying. What’s next?”

Emanuel Maiberg / *404 Media*. Jul. 23, 2025. “Google’s AI Is Destroying Search, the Internet, and Your Brain.”

Casey Newton / *Platformer*. Jul. 22, 2025. “The Google study that told us what we already suspected.”